1. Purpose

TD SYNNEX currently does not support phish-resistant MFA when accessing end user Microsoft Entra ID tenants. This document is intended to explain the reasoning behind the MFA methods supported.

Note: This document is accurate on the effective date shown. Changes may have occurred after its release. Contact TD SYNNEX Cloud Engineering for more information.

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3. Reference

The acceptable MFA methods for an end user tenant are set in the end user tenant. Microsoft has enabled Microsoft Authenticator in every tenant by default and they are enabling FIDO2 for new tenants by default. All other methods must be enabled by the end user in their tenant. The majority of hundreds of thousands of tenants under TD SYNNEX only have the default enabled.

TD SYNNEX accesses the end user tenant using passthrough authentication meaning that we authenticate in our own tenant and the parameters are passed to the end user tenant. For the end user tenant to allow us access when they require MFA, we must satisfy the methods they find acceptable. If we do not, then we are blocked. This is why we get blocked when and end user requires phish-resistant MFA.

TD SYNNEX has thousands of engineers across the globe who interact with end user tenants on a daily basis. They would need to try multiple MFA methods when they get denied access to a tenant. When denied, there is no indication as to why. It could be due to MFA or some other restriction. This would not be scalable across all customers.

TD SYNNEX uses Microsoft Authenticator with number matching for all access. This helps overcome the risk from MFA fatigue attacks. This option works with all tenants by default. Microsoft has provided a method to exclude TD SYNNEX from conditional access policies requiring phish-resistant MFA so we can still support the customer – such as provisioning subscriptions, opening support cases, provisioning RIs, etc.

Accepting the limitations placed on us by Microsoft, TD SYNNEX has a very robust security posture. We use isolated identities, use least trust access, mandate 100% MFA use, use conditional access with risky user/session detection, approval process for any access, use EDR protected devices, conduct regular security training, automatic removal of credentials, and monitor our tenants with Sentinel.

4. Definitions

Term	*Definition*
EDR	Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) is a cybersecurity technology designed to continuously monitor and respond to threats on endpoint devices such as computers, mobile phones, and IoT devices.
FIDO2	FIDO2 (Fast IDentity Online 2) is an open authentication standard developed by the FIDO Alliance. It aims to provide a more secure and user-friendly alternative to traditional password-based authentication.
Identity isolation	Identity isolation is the practice of isolating user identities and their associated credentials to prevent unauthorized access and reduce the risk of security breaches
Least trust access	Least trust access involves granting users and devices the minimum level of access necessary to perform their tasks, thereby reducing the risk of unauthorized access and potential security breaches
MFA	Multifactor Authentication (MFA) is an electronic authentication method that enhances security by requiring users to provide two or more verification factors to gain access to a website or application.
MFA fatigue attack	MFA fatigue attacks occur when users are bombarded with multiple authentication requests, leading them to accidentally approve a malicious request.
Phish-resistant MFA	Phish-resistant Multifactor Authentication (MFA) is a type of MFA designed to be more secure against phishing attacks. Traditional MFA methods, like SMS-based codes or push notifications, can be vulnerable to phishing, where attackers trick users into revealing their authentication codes or approving fraudulent login attempts.
Microsoft Authenticator	Microsoft Authenticator is an application from Microsoft that provides an additional layer of security for online accounts through two-factor authentication (2FA).

5. Associated Documents

- Announcing mandatory multi-factor authentication for Azure sign-in | Microsoft Azure Blog

6. Document Approval

This document has been approved by:

- Manager, Cloud Sales Engineering

7. Document Revision History

Number	*Effective Date*	*Revision History*	*Author*
1.0	9/24/2024	Initial Draft	David Bloom